



Cambridge (CIE) IGCSE English Language



Your notes

Paper 2

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Paper 2 is the optional second exam for the CIE IGCSE English Language course. You *must* take Paper 1, but for the rest of the IGCSE you may either be sitting Paper 2 as an exam or completing a coursework portfolio. You must take *either* Paper 2 or Component 3 (coursework).

Paper 2 overview

The Paper 2 exam (called Directed Writing and Composition) is 2 hours long and you will answer two questions: Question 1 and Question 2, 3, 4 or 5. The exam is worth 80 marks. These marks are divided into two skills – reading and writing – as follows:

- Total marks for writing = 65
- Total marks for reading = 15

As well as your question paper and answer booklet, you will also be given an insert containing one or two texts. Question 1 is compulsory and based on the reading texts. Both questions are worth 40 marks, so you should divide your time equally between the two questions. Although you are mainly assessed for writing on this paper, you should be aware that there are up to 15 marks available for reading in Question 1.

Paper 2 breakdown

Question	What you are asked to do
Section A: Directed Writing	This question will be based on one or two texts
	You will be asked to write 250–350 words in response to the task
	You will be required to evaluate and develop the information in the text(s) – using some of the same skills as in Paper 1 Question 3
	You will be asked to create a discursive /argumentative/persuasive response, using your own words, in one of the following formats: speech, letter or article
Section B: Composition	Section B offers a choice of four questions: two descriptive writing questions (Questions 2 and 3) and two narrative writing questions (Questions 4 and 5)

You should choose **one title** (either Question 2, 3, 4 or 5) and use the title to develop and write a composition of 350–450 words

What skills are being assessed

There are only two assessment objectives for this IGCSE, each worth 50% of your overall grade. These are then divided into sub-objectives. Because the majority of marks in this paper come from writing, the table below starts with AO2:

AO2: write accurately and effectively, using Standard English appropriately	Sub-objective	What this means
	W1: articulate experience and express what is thought, felt and imagined	Write convincingly to convey real and imagined experiences, thoughts and feelings
	W2: organise and structure ideas and opinions for deliberate effect	Sequence and connect the ideas and opinions effectively within your written response to interest and influence your reader
	W3: use a range of vocabulary and sentence structures appropriate to context	Use a range of appropriate vocabulary and sentence structures deliberately within each written response to achieve certain effects
	W4: use register appropriate to context	Vary your writing to suit the purpose, audience and form of the task
	W5: make accurate use of spelling, punctuation and grammar	Write accurately, avoiding spelling, punctuation and grammar errors

AO1: read and respond in different ways to different types of text	Sub-objective	What this means
	R1: demonstrate understanding of explicit meanings	Show that you understand the obvious meanings communicated in a text
	R2: demonstrate understanding of implicit meanings and	Show that you can recognise hints and suggestions in a text to understand the



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	attitudes	more hidden meanings and attitudes of the writer
	R3: analyse, evaluate and develop facts, ideas and opinions, using appropriate support from the text	- Evaluate and analyse the facts, ideas and opinions you read by using, explaining and developing them - Refer to supporting evidence from the text where appropriate, such as using quotations or references to the text
	R4: demonstrate understanding of how writers achieve effects and influence readers	- Show that you understand how a writer has influenced their reader through their use of language - Consider the deliberate choices a writer has made and why they have made those choices
	R5: select and use information for specific purposes	Select and use relevant and appropriate information from a text to answer the different questions

You can find detailed notes on how to answer each question on this paper in the following revision guides:

- Question 1: Directed Writing
- Section B: Composition